



The abduction phenomenon

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER

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No scientist respected in his field would seriously consider giving a scientific opinion on some matter not in his own area of expertise unless he had studied the matter for himself and was familiar with previous respected work done in that area.... This axiom seems to hold everywhere in the scientific world, but the UFO phenomenon seems to be a notable exception. Here scientists and uninformed laymen alike feel free to pontificate far and wide.... An astrophysicist, for example, would not think of expressing an expert opinion on brain surgery or other medical matters, nor would a brain surgeon attempt to speak learnedly about magnetohydrodynamics. Yet both types can be found who have definite opinions (expressed, of course, as facts) about UFOs without being in the least bit qualified to do so.

J. Allen Hynek
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EDITORIAL

Contact fantasies and abduction realities by Budd Hopkins

On the road (with visitors) by Whitley Strieber

The third option: how they got here, and why by Michael D. Swords

Observation of an alien figure by I. Scott

The Delphos landing: new evidence from the laboratory by Erol A. Faruk

The BUFORA conference by Jenny Randles

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Abductions: the case for a rational approach

A milestone of sorts may have been reached on April 10, 1987, when Dr. Robert J. Lifton, one of this country's most prominent psychiatrists, acknowledged on NBC's *Today Show* that the UFO-abduction phenomenon has yet to be explained and merits serious investigation.

As those who read the UFO literature (a category that does not include ufology's critics, as we shall see shortly) are aware, Dr. Lifton is not the first highly-credentialed mental-health professional to be intrigued and puzzled by these reports, although to the best of my knowledge Lifton is the first to state as much on national television. When Budd Hopkins embarked on his pioneering investigation of abductees, he wisely sought the assistance of a respected psychologist with no previous involvement in the UFO controversy, Dr. Aphrodite Clamar of New York University. In due course other professionals were drawn into the research (which is ongoing), interviewing abductees and giving them standard psychological tests.

Every professional who has participated in this kind of direct investigation asserts that *there is no known psychological explanation for these experiences*. All agree that abductees have gone through something extremely stressful. In fact, three psychologists who subjected a group of abductees to a battery of tests determined that the typical abductee has the psychological profile of a victim of personal assault -- which, as one of the professionals who took part in the study observed, is just what one would expect if the reported experiences really happened.

This same psychologist, Dr. Elizabeth Slater of New York City, said an abductee is like "the rape victim, who has been violated most brutally but somehow becomes tainted by virtue of the crime against her." Her point was that, just as society holds that rape victims somehow asked for it and therefore don't merit our sympathy, so abductees deserve only ridicule and contempt because they must be lunatics or liars.

One case in point is a bizarre statement attributed to MIT physicist Philip Morrison (*Philadelphia Inquirer*, March 8), who, when asked about abduction reports, sputtered, "Go into a state hospital, and every 10th person will tell you



Jerome Clark

the same story." The same newspaper article has this goofy assessment from humanist philosopher Paul Kurtz (from whom I would have expected a lot better): "What do you think of people who see pink elephants? Have you heard of hallucinogenics? Schizophrenics?" A *Chicago Tribune* writer sagely declared that abductions need not be taken seriously because abductees are "tedious oafs."

Where the abduction phenomenon is concerned, there are two camps. The first camp consists of those who have investigated it and who have concluded that something strange, unexplained and potentially important is going on. The second camp is made up of those who have not investigated it, have not examined the evidence but nonetheless "know" -- presumably by psychic means -- that there is nothing to it.

In a free society everyone, including scientists and philosophers, has the right to make foolish and unfounded statements in public. And of course, when one is confronting something so unsettling as the abduction phenomenon, ignorance and denial are understandable human responses. Ignorance and denial, however, will not add to human knowledge.

Those who care more for science than for their own prejudices can agree on this much: The abduction phenomenon, whatever its causes, exists. It does not arise from any known psychiatric disorder. Those persons who experience it suffer mightily from its effects. There is a body of evidence that suggests something extraordinary may be going on. *That* is where the debate should start from.

Meaningless insults directed against abductees and investigators of abduction experiences may soothe the psyches of those who would rather ridicule than think, but they can only retard science's efforts to uncover the true source (internal or external) of the abduction experience. Unbiased inquiry, which is where all real science begins, is the only rational approach to this or any other question. -- Jerome Clark

Contact fantasies and abduction realities

by Budd Hopkins

Budd Hopkins, a well-known New York artist, is ufology's leading investigator of the abduction phenomenon. He is the author of *Missing Time* (1981) and *Intruders*, recently published by Random House.

Shirley MacLaine's recent television saga cannot have escaped the attention of many UFO researchers. In its final climactic moments, *Out on a Limb* surely encapsulated for all time the "Space Brothers" view of the UFO phenomenon as a quasi-religion. In this reading, angelic female extraterrestrials hand out magic bracelets, answer prayers and are present on earth basically to "guide us away from our materialistic natures."

A very short time after the program aired, I received a call from UFO investigator Bill Heinzerling. A resident of Vermont, Bill was in the New York City area and asked if he could visit me and bring along a friend of his, a man who was deeply interested in the UFO phenomenon. His friend, whom I shall call "Dave," had had a series of unusual UFO sightings, vivid dreams and half-memories which strongly suggested an unremembered abduction experience.

Bill also said that Dave had a woman friend whom he was eager to bring along because of her interest in the subject. Bill, Dave and "Christie" arrived at my studio on January 21, and we chatted over coffee and sandwiches. Fortunately, neither Dave nor Christie had read *Missing Time*, my book on the abduction phenomenon, and Christie, I discovered, knew virtually nothing about this kind of report.

The key to Christie's attitude toward the UFO phenomenon lay in her total acceptance of the Space Brothers interpretation. Recently she had participated in a workshop in which she and a number of other people were led into a meditative state; they then "directed their energies upward" to the skies and "into a huge spaceship named Excalibur." They "wandered mentally" inside the UFO, chatting with beautiful space beings, and later "returned to their bodies" and compared notes. As one might have guessed, each had a different recollection of the encounter.

As we sat in my kitchen and talked, Christie began to realize that the type of abduction account I was alluding to had nothing to do with her self-induced mental experience. She seemed even a little annoyed when I asserted that people sometimes suffered psychologically damaging aftereffects as a result of these traumatic encounters.

But at that point my attention and my questions were directed to Dave, and I asked him about any unusual childhood memories, experiences or dreams that he recalled and about which he harbored nagging, unresolved feelings. After he answered, Christie suddenly spoke up: "I've always had some kind of feeling that I was molested when I was about five years old, but I could never remember by whom...or anything else about it. I'm not sure it really happened. It's just kind of a strange feeling."

I made a mental note to inquire further about that, but then I went on to ask Dave if there was any place -- a room or field or highway or whatever -- about which he felt a definite sense of fear or dread or the like. As he answered this question I noticed that Christie once more seemed very thoughtful -- lost in her own reveries. "It's funny you brought that up," she said. "When I was little I used to be afraid of this hill where there was a water tower, and I don't know why."

The replies that Dave had been making to my inquiries only deepened my sense that he had experienced a consciously-unremembered UFO encounter. Though Christie's recollections had been suggestive, I still did not feel there was anything especially unusual about them, particularly when I considered her steadfast Shirley MacLaine view of the phenomenon. Perhaps she had been molested as a child and had somehow blocked the details; that is a common enough experience, unfortunately. And many people, I suppose, are afraid of certain childhood places.

I was more immediately interested in the details of Dave's case, which I cannot go into here. (Several days later, when I began to explore his recollections through regressive hypnosis, a series of abduction accounts surfaced dramatically. The investigation is ongoing.) When

I brought up the issue of regressive hypnosis -- Dave was familiar with the Betty and Barney Hill case -- he said that he would like to think over the implications of such a process. But to my surprise Christie spoke up, saying, "I'd like to try it if Dave won't, though there's probably nothing to remember. I've always been curious about hypnosis."

We talked further, particularly about matters of health. Christie had had, at one time, some psychotherapy, but she appeared stable and healthy. Her only medical anomaly was an odd problem with one of her ovaries; eventually it had to be removed. Christie is an attractive woman in her early 30s and a successful graphic artist. She is open and charming, and, possibly as a result of her experiences with meditation, an excellent hypnotic subject.

But there was a problem: what were we going to explore? There was no specific event, no peculiar incident, no sighting -- nothing, really, but the sense that she might have had some kind of sexual experience when she was about five years old, and the fact that she was afraid of a certain hill where there was a water tower. I explained that we might, indeed, discover that she had been molested as a child and that if that were true I would help her recall it with as little fear as possible. She assured me that if it were true she could handle it and that she was eager to try hypnosis.

I took a long time inducing the trance state, calming her, reassuring her that she was safe. I had her recall her childhood friends, her yard, the places she liked to play. After a while I gave her these instructions: "Go inside your body, feel all its sensations and ask your body if it experiences any unusual sensations" -- this after reminding her of her remark about feeling molested as a little girl. It was a leading direction, I admit, but if there had been a traumatic childhood sexual incident I wanted to uncover it.

"Your body may have had some kind of contact of some sort that wasn't welcome, but maybe not," I said. "You can feel and remember...search those feelings, and if there's anything you'd like to tell me, you can speak whenever you want to. You're very safe...."

Her first words, surprisingly, dealt with something else and she described the time oddly.

C: This would have been later...this would have been soon after. I had to get a shot...I had to go to

the doctor, which I'd done before, but I just...went insanely hysterical...and just completely lost control. I just couldn't let him do it. I would have died before I'd let him give me the shot. He didn't do it. He tried to talk me into it...my parents were very angry and took me home....

BH: Where was the shot? In your arm or your backside, or where?

C: It would have been in my arm. It was a booster shot.

I asked what it was that she was specifically afraid of, and she replied that she "just couldn't let it happen. I do know it hurts, but I've had them before. It just feels like...survival." Christie explained that the man had been her doctor all her life and that she trusted him. He had given her stitches and shots before, but "it's just this day...it's different. I trust him but I can't let him do it."

My next question, innocent though it seemed, brought an immediate response. "Have you had shots like this before in your arms?" I asked.

Christie suddenly began to cry, then explained, "Just when you said that, about shots in the arm...."

I calmed her, assuring her she was safe, while she went on, trying to explain what was upsetting her: "I think it's...a restraining...." She did not explain what she meant by that, but somehow the mention of needles and her arms implied that she was somehow being restrained, held, unable to move. I asked if her doctor had tried to force the injection, but she said that he had been understanding and had let her go home without having received the inoculation. She described her memories of having to get ready to go to the doctor's that day and trying to hide from her parents. Her tears continued, along with a deep undercurrent of obvious fear.

In any case, the next step was to try to make her fears more specific in order to ventilate them more efficiently. I was beginning to form an idea of what bothered her so much that one time at the doctor's office, so I decided to try another tack. I explained that one can have a shot in any part of one's body. A cut in the foot might require stitches and a local anesthetic. Injections can be made anywhere. I proposed starting at her feet and moving upwards toward her head in an attempt to localize her fears. I said that I would name each part of her body and that if she felt

anything unusual relating to the idea of an injection she should tell me so. If her sensations were normal she should simply say "normal." I asked her to picture a needle as we inventoried her bodily sensations.

There were no unusual feelings in her feet. Her lower legs felt "tight" but otherwise normal. Her thighs felt "maybe a little more tense...." I moved to her hips and buttocks, and she said that she could remember getting "real shots there." But before I could move on, she said, "I think my belly...it's like my skin is trying to crawl away from...something." She paused. "Below my navel...."

As investigators are aware, many UFO abductees have described lying flat and being unable to move while a long needle pierces the abdominal wall. I made a mental note to return to Christie's discomfort in that area while I moved our bodily inventory upwards, naming her chest and upper body. There were no unusual sensations in that area. "If anything," she said, "my throat, maybe."

I moved higher, announcing that we would catalogue her other facial features in relation to the idea of a needle. "How about your nose?" I asked. Her answer was interesting: "I can imagine the feeling but I don't know...." I asked what that meant and delivered another deliberately misleading-leading question: "Like something piercing the side of your nostril?" She corrected this immediately, saying, "Well, up and through, going through the cartilage. Ugh." She shivered at the thought.

I reassured her once again that whatever these "dreams or memories" were, they happened long ago and that she was safe now.

I still was curious if Christie had seen anything unusual, though it was obvious she was reluctant to move outside the relative safety of her own body. In order to allow the subject at such times to view his or her surroundings with a minimum of fear, I have developed a device that I call the "black curtain." I ask the witness to picture a double thick black velvet drop that comes together like a theater curtain, in two pieces. The subject must imagine its thickness, its texture, its blackness. The curtain provides a shield against whatever is going on around him or her. I explain that I will count to three and at the count of three the subject will open the curtain a mere crack and peek out; then the curtain is closed. The individual is protected, yet is able to describe the surroundings. This device has proven

successful, allowing a hypnotized subject to report anything from a quick glimpse to prolonged observation.

I described the black curtain to Christie, and told her that when she peeked out she might see anything -- a doctor's office, an accident scene or whatever -- and that it might even be blank on the other side. But I assured her that she would probably see something having to do with the feelings she had been describing to me. I counted to three and then asked her what she saw.

C: I don't know if it was anything or not, but it was back up by the watertower...I was...[sighs deeply]...I guess it's me on one side of the watertower leaving, getting out of there, and there's something on the other side...in the field. [Beginning to cry] I feel tricked.

BH: I'm just interested in your feelings...they're extremely important to you and to me. Just tell me how you feel.

C: [Coldly, sadly] Like a lab rat that just got let loose.

BH: Christie, I want you to do this for me right now. Whatever that is, or whoever let you loose, I want you to speak with or to them or whatever, and tell what you feel right now. I want your real feelings. You said you feel tricked. Tell them what you feel. Speak to them.

C: [Crying, and in a little girl's perplexed voice] It's not fair.

BH: It isn't fair. And you have every right to tell them it isn't fair.

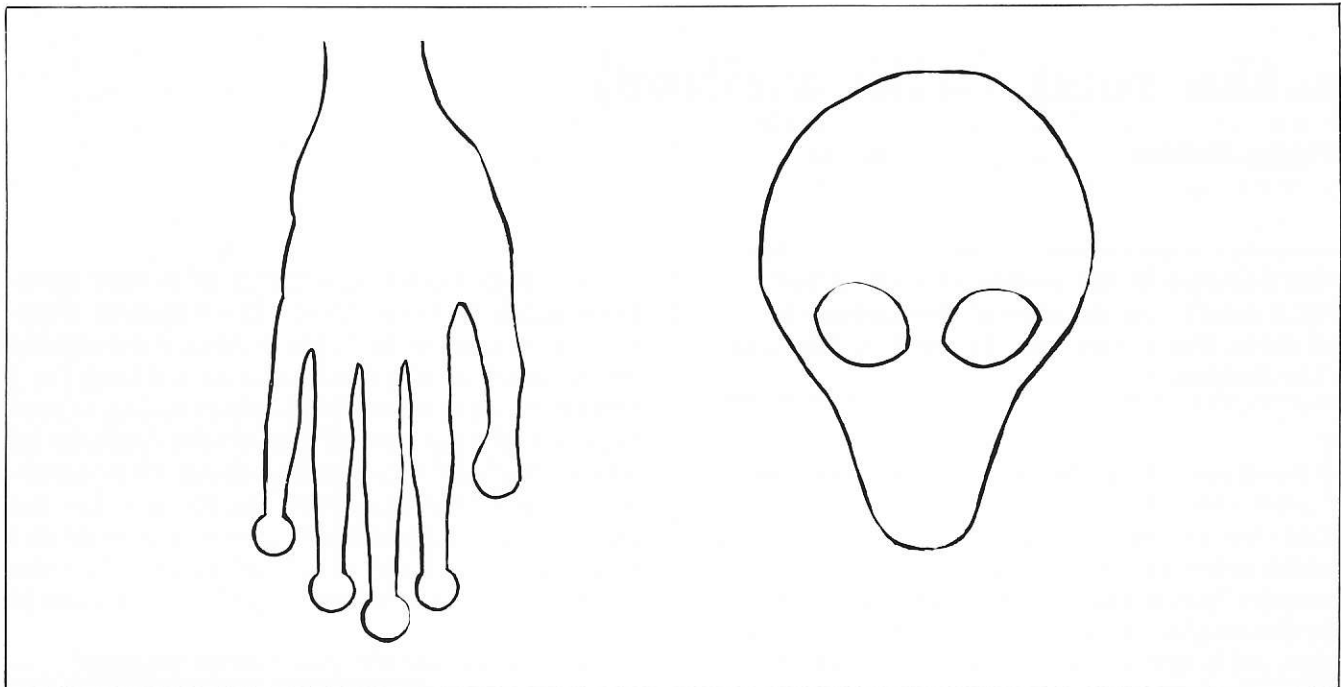
C: But I'm afraid to say anything. [Crying] They cheated me somehow. I don't know how I got there. Maybe they called me somehow? I don't know. I'm not even supposed to be there.

BH: How does your body feel as you leave there?

C: Weak...and helpless. Powerless.

BH: You said they tricked you. Do you see anybody who might have done the tricking?

C: Figures...they've got very long hands...long fingers, and there are a lot of them around me, doing things. I'm lying down. Just like a lab rat.



Christie's sketches of humanoid's hand and face

B.H.: [Asking another deliberately leading question] Are they nice?

C: [Speaking quickly, immediately] No! They're not nice. I'm nothing. I'm a zero.

The session continued, but perhaps it is best now to try to summarize its content. Christie described the figures as being thin, gray-skinned and hairless. The most traumatic moments came when she recalled a needle piercing her lower abdomen in the region of her left ovary, while a second slender needle entered her vagina. (Her account closely parallels that of a Minnesota woman who, under hypnosis, described these same operations taking place during a UFO abduction which occurred when she was also five years old. She described the angle of insertion of the abdominal needle as implying that it and the vaginal [uterine] probe might have come together somewhere inside her body.) There are many more details to Christie's account, but I feel we know now why she thought she might have been sexually molested as a child, why she had a sudden aversion to visiting her doctor for an injection, and why she was always afraid of the area near the watertower.

Two more hypnotic sessions have disclosed a second abduction -- the source of the scar on her leg -- and a most disturbing teenage encounter, all

of which require fuller description than space allows.

My reason for publishing this particular account at this time has to do with the myth of the benign Space Brothers. Christie, formerly a believer in this view, has obviously changed her mind. Experience tells. Shirley MacLaine and cultist hopes to the contrary, the real UFO experience is sobering, not blissful. One wonders how many real abductees there might be attending seminars, traveling "mentally" to distant starships, working hard to keep the reality of their unremembered experiences at bay.

Coming in *IUR*...

The case of the big green men,
by Bronislaw Rzepecki

**How science will solve the UFO
mystery,**
by I. Scott

When Blue Book met the ufologists,
by Willard D. Nelson

On the road (with visitors)

by Whitley Strieber

Whitley Strieber is the author of *Communion* (1987), a nonfiction account of his abduction experiences. His novels include *Warday*, *Catmagic* and *The Wolfen*.

I have just completed an 18-city author tour for *Communion*. As of this writing, the book is number two on the *New York Times* bestseller list and sales are very strong. The *Times* has called *Communion* "powerfully written and involving."

At the beginning of the tour I was literally sleepless with dread. I could hear the jeering, see television and radio personalities dissolve into gales of helpless laughter as I became to every household in America "the writer who thinks he got taken aboard a flying saucer by little men."

It wasn't like that. It wasn't like that at all. Here is what really happened.

I have been on over 40 live television and radio shows, including such national programs as *Good Morning, America*, *The Phil Donahue Show* and *Sally Jesse Raphael*. On these programs I have been before 15 live audiences ranging in size from 50 to 700 persons. I have taken 218 telephone calls on the air. In the past six weeks I have received over 500 letters from *Communion* readers responding to the address in the back of the book. I am now receiving letter mail at the rate of 20 pieces a day.

To respond to this outpouring of correspondence I have hired two secretaries. We are able to process approximately 50 responses a day from dictation that I do at night, so the stack is getting smaller. Because of the intensely difficult nature of the experiences described, I feel that I must read and respond to each letter personally.

These letters probably represent one of the largest repositories of the visitor experience ever assembled. Unidentified copies of the texts will be cataloged into a database by a group of professional psychologists, and follow-up studies of selected volunteers will be carried out, to include an extensive array of mental and physical tests. This work will be funded by a nonprofit organization I have founded and financed, tentatively entitled the Triad Group.

The overwhelming number of letters have been positive. Three have been negative. Five have appeared to be from seriously disorganized minds. Most of the letters are as striking for their articulate style as for their astonishing content. Eighty-eight percent of the letters describe some sort of "visitor" experience. About 40 percent report an actual abduction. Many describe major changes in the abductees' consciousness or in their spiritual life. To me this is of absolutely central importance in understanding this phenomenon.

After seeing the *Sally Jesse Raphael* program, one researcher suggested that I refrain from mentioning that the visitors had inserted a needle into my brain because this had caused "snickering" in the audience. I believe that it is essential to an understanding of the true nature and significance of the visitor experience that people be encouraged to be totally candid about their perceptions. The editing of narrative to make it more palatable, neater or more believable should not be encouraged. Otherwise we may never come to a valid understanding of what is really happening.

Like me, many of my *Communion* correspondents are struggling with fear. Many are engaging in intense spiritual searches, and this is the part of their lives that interests me most. I have been on such a search for many years and have experimented with everything from mystical Christianity to Zen to witchcraft (of the white variety).

I believe that the abduction experience can be a productive one even when it is terribly frightening. It seems to me that we can train ourselves to accept it and to make good psychological use of it. It is possible to live comfortably at a high level of uncertainty, and I hope that *Communion* is communicating this to others.

The book has now been reviewed in quite a number of newspapers and magazines. In addition to the *New York Times*, the *Philadelphia Inquirer*, the *San Francisco Examiner*, the *Washington Post* and the *The Nation* magazine have all accorded it major attention.

While the *The Nation* was hostile, it also was careful to print many supportive quotes from me and has accorded me a right of reply. One of the witnesses to my experiences of October 4, 1985, has also replied to the review, reiterating her certainty that something very strange happened on that night.

There have also been articles published about the book in magazines far more important than *The Nation*, such as *New York* magazine, *Omni*, and *Us*. These have all accorded it fair treatment. The most unfavorable review so far published appeared in the *San Francisco Chronicle*, which called the book "a lot of blather" and averred, "Swallow *Communion* and it could be your last sane supper."

Interestingly, neither *The Nation* nor the *Chronicle* made any effort to contact any of the scientists or witnesses associated with the book. My lawyers are exploring a libel action against the *Chronicle*, but I doubt that I will pursue it. I would rather it printed a letter of reply from me and I am negotiating with it on this matter.

The thrust of the *Chronicle* review was that, since I reported in *Communion* that my memory of being on the University of Texas campus on August 1, 1966, when Charles Whitman opened fire on the students, may have been faulty, I must be a compulsive liar. I have always remembered that horrible incident in great detail but discovered last year, while searching through my past for *Communion*, that the person whom I thought I was with, my *Warday* collaborator James Kunetka, had no memory of my being there. Out of scrupulousness I reported this fact in *Communion* even though my reminiscences about the incident had been published in a book of interviews of horror novelists called *Faces of Fear* and in *Twilight Zone* magazine.

I have subsequently found that I was indeed on the campus and in the exact location I remembered. The only lapse of memory was that I thought I was with James Kunetka. I was not. I've even discovered the reason why I was on campus in the middle of the summer: it was the 100th anniversary of the founding of a beloved student watering hole, Sholtz Beer Garden, and I had gone to the campus for the celebration.

Far from proving me a "liar" the scrupulousness of my reportage in *Communion* testifies to my obvious honesty.

One large radio station in the Midwest did a computer poll of its audience while I was on the

air and the results were that 78 percent of the listeners believed that I had been taken aboard a UFO by extraterrestrials. I was in the interesting position of being more skeptical about my own story than were my listeners!

I have been saying that I'm 80 percent convinced that the visitors are quite real. The 20 percent I give to the inescapable fact that there is no known physical artifact of their presence here. At least, no such artifact is known to the public. But if they are not real, then the human mind is engaged in a really spectacular flight of collective fancy. Should this be an entirely human phenomenon, it is considerably more amazing--and harder for science to deal with--than something as relatively prosaic as visitors from another world.

The love and support that have poured into my life as a result of *Communion* have been extraordinary and totally unexpected. They have moved me deeply, humbled me. How I underestimated the people and the media! I have met thousands of open minds, inquiring, careful, intelligent--and thus inclined to believe the truth: that something very strange is happening in our world, and it has to do with unidentified flying objects and their enigmatic occupants.

It is as if, during the past 10 or so years of quiescence--when many of those who investigate the phenomenon thought it might be dying--the visitors were by stealth of night planting a seed in the minds of millions of people. They did it by abductions, by incontrovertible sightings: it was, in effect, a direct appeal to the public consciousness. When they said to me, "We will come from within you," what they must have in part meant was that they would emerge not through our institutions but through the minds and experiences of everyday people.

I have not found much hostility on the road, or much willingness to laugh. With a few notable exceptions people have treated me with respect.

In part this is because it is obvious that anybody with as public a career as mine has a great deal to lose by making the assertions I have made. The financial motive isn't even there. I have made a good deal of money in my life, as is clear from my tax returns. I did not need money and could have made nearly as much for another novel--and spared myself the enormous effort that has been involved in presenting *Communion* effectively.

One thing *The Nation* review did was to convince me to take another look at my past work

and see if there was any common theme that would suggest that I was aware of the visitors during the years I was writing.

The Wolfen was about a species of super wolf as intelligent as man: nonhumans who preyed on human beings.

The Hunger was about a vampire who was really another species altogether but who appeared entirely human. She drew her immortality from preying on human beings.

Black Magic was about psychotronic weapons and mind control.

The Night Church concerned a group of anti-Catholics using Catholic churches for evil rituals.

On December 23, 1983, I had a startling experience: I perceived something standing behind me in my office in the middle of the night. When I swiveled my chair around I observed a tall being in a dark grey cowl. Its face looked like an archaic Greek portrait of Athene. I knew nothing then about visitors. I assumed that this was an entirely mental experience. Out of it there came an absolute and total change of mind. The next morning I began working on *Warday*, which is a heartfelt and scientifically accurate warning against limited nuclear war.

I completed the novel *Catmagic*, in which the fairy folk are a real species of intelligent nonhumans. They are manipulative but essentially benevolent, in the sense that their goal is the development of the human soul by a process of trial similar to the old shamanic initiation rituals where the searcher must face death or great suffering to gain enlightenment. They are small and even look a lot like the visitors. They may be my most exact unconscious rendering of them.

After that visitation my life changed completely. I ceased to be interested in concocting horror stories and began to write on issues of peace and the environment. I also became a much better craftsman of words that I had been before, to the point that my books began to win awards, which was a new experience for me.

Right after I had the experience of December 26, 1985, and before I had remembered much of it or understood any of it, I wrote a short story entitled "Pain" which is included in an anthology entitled *The Cutting Edge* (Doubleday, 1986). This story is about an encounter between a man and an extraordinarily powerful and beautiful woman, apparently an alien, who leads him to a higher state of consciousness through an ordeal. The story asserts that there is "something that feeds on human suffering," and that it is a "real

civilization, albeit with higher goals, motives and understanding than our own."

As it was completed after I read Peter Warrington and Jenny Randles' book *Science and the UFO*, it contains some material that actually seems to relate this "civilization" to UFOs and suggests that the reason that the government is hiding knowledge of their reality is that they are, in essence, predatory. "If what I was told was truly the content of this paper," the story's fictional narrator says, "then the obvious conclusion is that they use us for their own reasons, gaining something we do not understand from our suffering..." It continues, "To wreak mayhem in our world is not the responsibility of demons but of angels. It is their greatest and most painful duty, the one they hate for the agony they must cause, but love for the riches of understanding it brings."

Whether there is any truth in this or not I cannot say, but it is clear that these words were written by a man whose unconscious mind had been deeply affected by his recent perceptions.

The irony is that I have indeed experienced the exact sort of spiritual growth in recent months that the story attributes to the hideous stress of encounters with its own version of intelligent nonhumans.

On balance, the startling thematic repetition in my work certainly suggests that the idea of intelligent nonhuman beings has been one of the prime motivating factors behind my creative output.

To me, this is one of the most convincing aspects of my own experience. It is hard for me to believe that my persistent concerns about intelligent nonhumans emerged out of nowhere. They were not on my conscious mind, but when I went to my unconscious for a story idea, out they came. While my conscious mind was in amnesia, it is clear that the issue of the relationship between intelligent nonhumans and human beings was a major--if not *the* major--concern of my unconscious.

The public response to *Communion* has been very, very strong. It has revealed a fact that the media had previously been unsure of: there is far more public support for the scientists and researchers who take the UFO enigma seriously than for those who debunk it.

For the past 10 years the "scientific" debunkers have had almost sole access to national media. Programs like *Nova* have debunked UFOs.

Carl Sagan has publicly scoffed. Debunker positions have been featured in magazines such as *Discover*.

Apparently the public simply hasn't bought a word of it. The success of *Communion* strongly suggests that the public simply cannot be made to believe a lie, no matter how highly placed those who promote it may be.

When I have appeared on radio programs with debunkers, callers have literally ignored their existence in order to ask me about my experiences. I believe that the debunker community is in the process of being tuned out by certain public knowledge--gained through a vast amount of personal experience--that there is something awfully strange going on.

The UFO community would do well to become much more aggressive in presenting its case. The debunker position that nothing strange is happening is simply not believable, either to the media or to the public. Only two media personalities--Jim Althoff on KING radio in Seattle and Phil Donahue--were hostile. I have gotten 60 letters from the public congratulating me on my performance on Donahue, and the week after the show the book shot from number seven to number three on the bestseller list. This is a ringing endorsement of the book and a rejection of the negative position. A number of hosts who had been hostile to the UFO community in the past were open, receptive and courteous to me.

I doubt that this would have been true even 10 years ago. There is a very good reason for this change of attitude.

Eleven of the media personalities I encountered on the air privately related personal experiences of sightings or knew of sightings by trusted friends. One host realized while we were talking that he was himself an abductee. Many producers, even of major national programs, expressed their belief that there is a coverup on the UFO subject and their desire to see it end.

What has happened is that the public and the media have been won over by the persistence of the phenomenon. The sightings and abduction stories won't go away, and the "official" explanations are insufficient. Audience after audience laughed openly when I mentioned that a debunker had claimed that the recent Japanese Air Lines sighting involved misperceived planets.

The public is beginning to become aware that the compulsive debunkers are as much a part of

the crackpot fringe as the old-fashioned contactees.

The public is right to tar compulsive disbelievers and compulsive believers with the same brush. They are indeed two sides of the same coin. Both are fanatics and both are what they are for the same reason: they are afraid.

Many people in the intellectual and scientific communities fear disempowerment by a greater intelligence. This is a justifiable fear, but my own experience as an intellectual who has been pretty thoroughly involved with the visitors tells me that it is groundless. What has in fact happened to me is that my mind has been through a renaissance. Walls that I didn't even know were there have tumbled down. The universe and the works of God have been for me recharged with mystery and wonder.

The other group--those who make one blush with their contactee absurdities--are afraid for a different reason. I suspect that many of these people are abductees who found the experience so fearsome that they sublimated it into a more congenial belief system.

It may also be that some of the messages that have been reported by the contactee community are genuine. After all, if the visitors are real it follows that they can also communicate. Perhaps they do so.

This brings me to another point. The UFO community has spent years debating the debunkers. Thus the community is compelled to take the position that UFOs are "real" and by inference spacecraft from another planet, while the debunkers claim that this is not so. The truth is, though, the debunker argument is so hopelessly awry that it is hardly even admissible to rational discussion. The debunkers cannot prove that UFOs are not an entirely valid unknown. They cannot prove that abductees are "crazy" or "on drugs." Let Philip Klass debate "Sir" George King. The fanatical disbeliever and the fanatical believer belong together.

There is no reason why people holding mainstream opinions should expect to be paired off with obvious fanatics. If there is to be sensible debate, let it be between people who agree on the fundamental reality that something strange is taking place, but disagree about its nature.

It is my hope that the UFO community will begin to make its true position more clear: we know that something unusual is happening, but

continued on page 26

The third option: how they got here, and why

by Michael D. Swords

Michael D. Swords, Ph.D., associate professor of natural science at Western Michigan University, is the editor of CUFOS' *Journal of UFO Studies*.

Persons who refuse to take ufology seriously often argue that an extraterrestrial presence on earth is extremely improbable. It is an opinion that seems supported by established scientists, who are heard debating whether extraterrestrials even exist, and whether we should spend money trying to signal their stars.

Because scientists, as far as we know, don't have extraterrestrials to observe, weigh and measure, it is hardly surprising that they would argue this way, given the conservative no-risk attitudes that run endemic in the profession. But beyond these lab-tech-style scientists, science also lays claim to creative geniuses and cosmic visionaries.

It is surprising that the discussion of extraterrestrials has been limited to two options: they don't exist vs. they do but they can't get here. This paper is about the (relatively) undiscussed third option: they exist, they *can* get here, but their presence is not obvious, so why not? I define "obvious" as "so easy and clear as to be unmistakable to the general mass of humanity." On that definition, the presence of extraterrestrials in our solar system is certainly not obvious, nor can any of us simply make it obvious to others by demonstration.

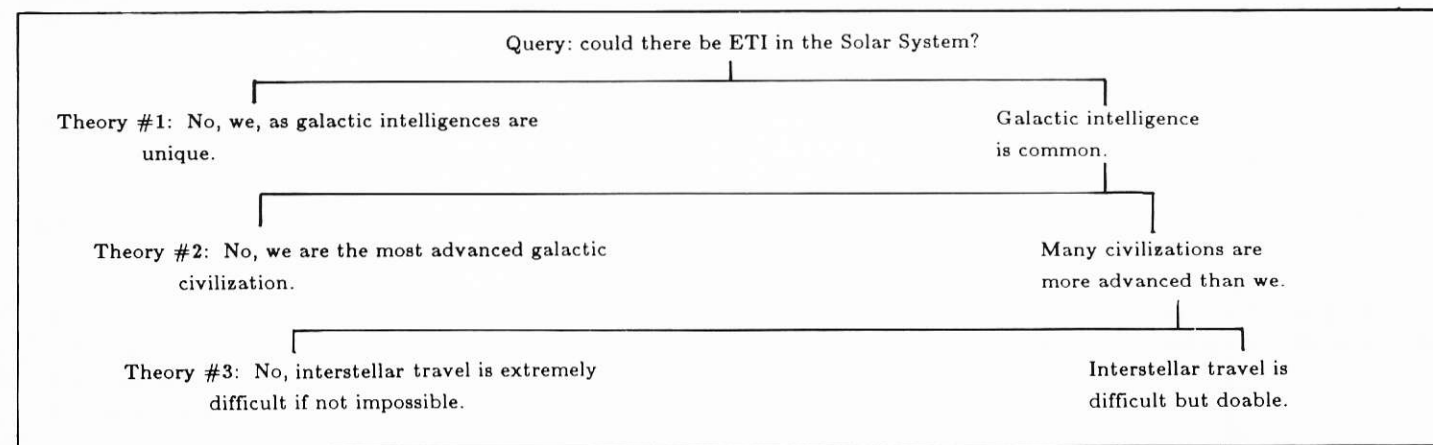
Here is a "decision tree" to help focus the discussion:

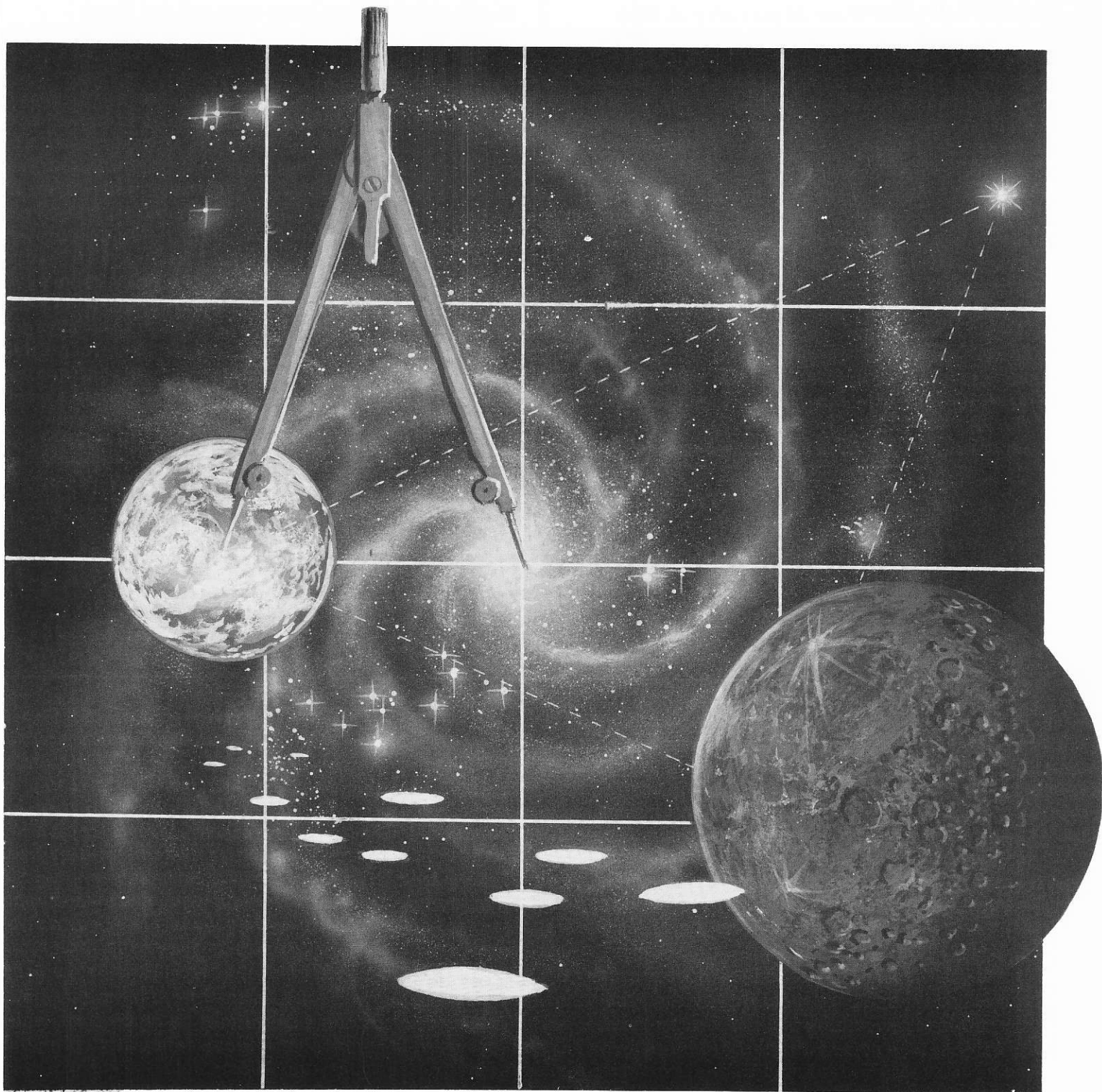
Hard data are not available for these research questions. But we know much that is relevant.

All of frontier knowledge in the sciences points to the conclusion that galactic intelligence should be common. A flock of authors (including me) have defended this view in endless pages elsewhere, arguing that thousands of technical civilizations (at a minimum) must exist in the galaxy. If new problems with the idea arise tomorrow, well, fair enough. But today the "certainty" seems well beyond 99 percent. It is a "best guess" which also directs itself to Theory #2.

Given the likelihood of thousands or more technical civilizations, even the random statistical odds of earth's being the most advanced are almost zero. But it may even be worse than that. Theories of galactic system formation hold that star systems form earlier closer to the nucleus, and later out toward the edges of the disc. Since we are well out toward the edge, 60 percent or more, we have even more reason to believe that we are a Johnny-come-lately to the high-technology game. Almost all the advanced civilizations are more advanced than we.

Theory #3 is not much more difficult to reason about. On the one hand, we have already envisioned a multiplicity of star-trekking techniques from gravity-boosted fusion engines to microwave lightsails. These concepts, admittedly big projects, should create 15-to 20-percent light speeds and could reach the neighborhood stars. Even if our technology could progress only so far as these designs at its peak, it is almost inconceivable that we *Homo sapiens* wouldn't go for it sooner or later when we became energy-





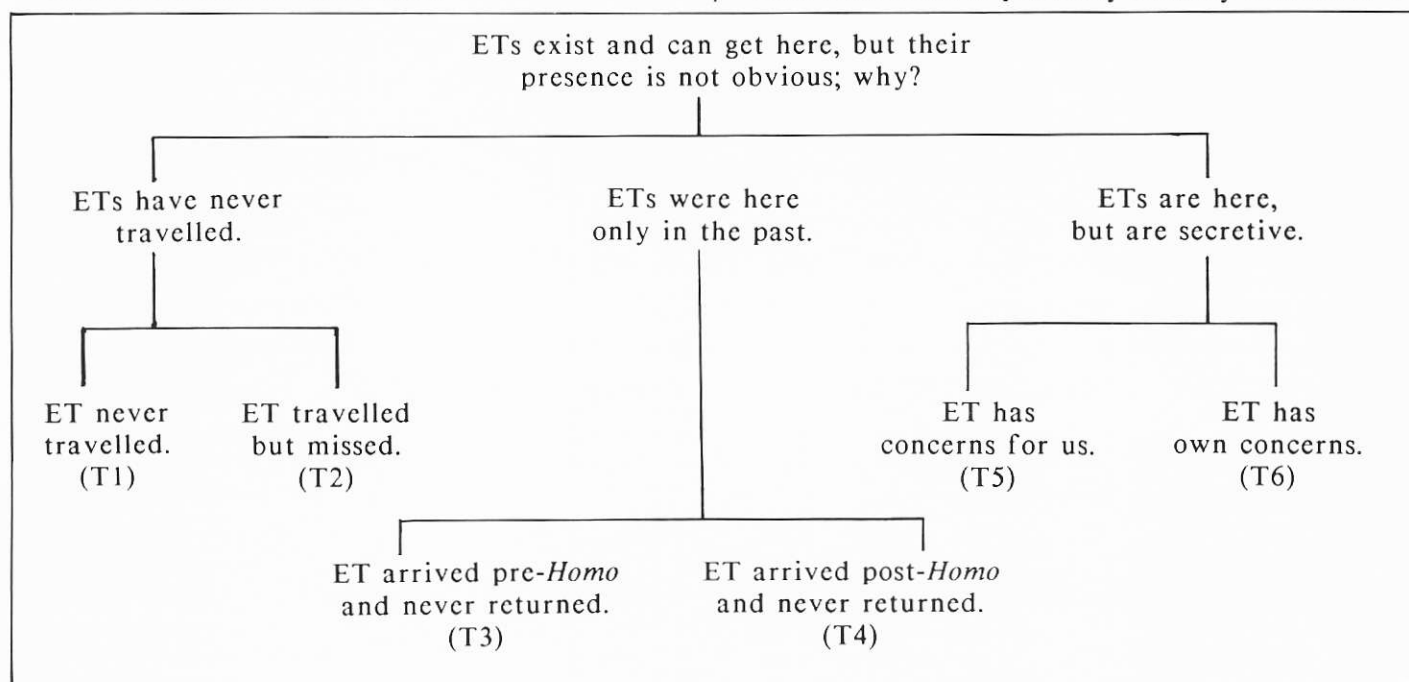
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and-materials-rich enough through space-based civilization centers and space resources technology. And that novel, so-far-unthought-of abilities will arise seems historically certain.

That much seems relatively uncontroversial. Puzzling, is it not, that most of us could feel 99-percent certain that

a) many extraterrestrials exist;
b) many are more advanced than we;
and c) they can get from "there" to here,
but we are still not seriously discussing the "third option," which would open the way for respectful treatment of UFO research as one potential element in the pursuit of the truth.

Here's another decision tree:



Even though this decision tree is a hypothetical exercise (especially at this point), I feel confident that it covers the major logical possibilities and sets a groundwork for discussion.

Theory #1: the better-things-to-do hypothesis

At first thought this seems to be a powerful possibility. What "better things" are there? *Materially*, we need to provide for all our species members, create an efficient and ecologically sound sustaining system of production, and do what Buckminster Fuller termed as "making available the Bare Maximum" to a creative and curious population (but one not mired in useless materialism). There could also be massive

materials-intensive research-exploration projects not involving star-travel, which might seem more significant or interesting. *Spiritually*, it could be that civilizations-at-large turn toward inner quests via states of consciousness, psychic or spiritualist exploration.

Let's meditate on that. An advanced intelligent civilization almost by definition has created a self-sustaining system for provision of material needs. Part of that system must encompass coherent attitudes or values in the populace, at the least involving a rejection of waste and spoiled un-discipline. Any advanced self-sustaining civilization has achieved population, energy and resources stability. The Bare Maximum is probably already available. If

these things weren't true, the civilization would collapse. Even if it were not spiritually evolved, it would at least have figured out how to survive.

And if the surviving advanced systems have their survival needs provided for, what do they do with the surplus bounty of their sun and their space minerals? Maybe nothing. Maybe they just settle into their cyclical system and get in touch with the Flow of Life. Probably lots of individuals in such a world would do just that. It's hard to believe, however, that the dynamic drive to discovery that brought the civilization to this advanced state would just suddenly die.

Advanced technical civilizations almost certainly continue to explore. It's almost intuitively obvious, isn't it? It's in *our* blood

certainly. Could other unsuspected big exploration projects arise which would exhaust the surplusses and stop the deep-space program? Sure. Maybe. For a while. Forever? Probably not. Sooner or later it seems probable that they, like us, will go for it. It's just too darned interesting not to try to contact more folks like us.

So what about the spiritual hypothesis? It seems clear how and why such an inner-quest fixation might turn off interest in external exploration. If the inner-quest had obvious pay-offs, then it could well change the explorative behavior of an entire civilization. Would all technically advanced civilizations turn from external energy-and-materials-intensive explorations toward eco-cosmic inner-quests? Both visions are attractive. Some may go one way, some another, some both together. The inner-quest vision almost always contains a Cosmic Unity component, which could easily drive a religious outer-quest as well.

I suspect that civilizations must continue questing in some form or another, or they will stagnate and die. It is a view gained from our own rich histories on this planet. And it is an intuition growing not only from gut feelings but from the work on change, perturbation, growth, and evolution by Ilya Prigogine, the Nobelist and one of the great thinkers of the 20th Century. Advanced civilizations that have settled into some totalitarian restrictive vision-lock will not be self-sustaining no matter how clever their technical provision system has become. The sustaining advanced civilizations *might be* "totalitarian," but in an odd version of the term: allowing maximal rights and freedoms to creatively quest as individuals, while maintaining iron-fisted control over the big systems of provision. Such a government reduces to a highly placed servant, however, and as soon as power begins to be abused the civilization will begin to destabilize. In such a civilization, however, the decision *not* to explore other possible civilizations would be more likely (due to concerns that new ideas would threaten security or destabilization).

Intuitive conclusions about Theory #1:

1A. Civilizations of this type will either disintegrate (and no longer apply as advanced high-tech) or get there in time. Most will get there.

1B. Civilizations of this orientation would need to continue to discover bigger and bigger non-space projects to occupy them. Certainly all the civilizations will not do this.

1C. Civilizations of this type might well fear other examples unlike themselves. How many self-sustaining liberty-emphasizing civilizations will become totalitarian yet service oriented? It seems an unlikely mix. Would less totalitarian civilizations be so afraid of others that they wouldn't go? Maybe. But there's even an argument that they'd be *more* likely to go and see for security reasons (for fear of our surprising them suddenly).

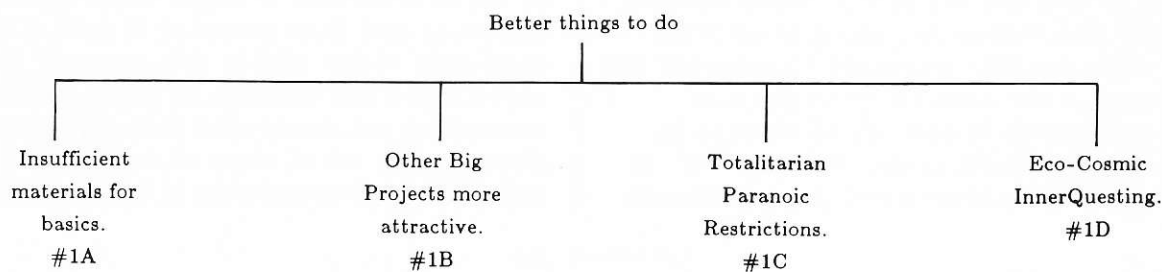
1D. Civilizations of this sort might well exist. It's hard to believe that all the high-tech civilizations "turn away" this way. If the exclusively inner-quest civilizations are really onto something, they may be in contact by other means anyway.

Summary: The most natural thing for us to do would be to follow the path we've always followed: Try to provide for our physical needs and security, explore widely in all elements of existence and, we hope, achieve a self-sustaining system which continues to allow personal growth and species exploration. I would believe that this is also the normal evolution of things out there. Theory #1 depletes the number of exploring civilizations but is not the majority situation.

Theory #2: the geographical-bad-luck hypothesis

If, as the trends of modern knowledge suggest, many extraterrestrial civilizations have

Theory #1 decision tree



arisen in the galaxy, some of these civilizations should have appeared far in the past. The Milky Way should have had a seven- or eight- billion-year life-bearing period, which would have had the first advanced civilizations appearing two billion years or so ago. There has been a lot of time to explore.

In terms of crude expansion modeling, it has been often shown that it is possible to get around to all the available stars in time periods much less than the time available to take the trips. But the models are crude. They point to relatively smooth expansion rates and are mathematically like filling a sphere from a point in the center. The fact that the galaxy is not at all like a sphere should have a marked slowing effect on the rate of exploration. It's just possible that some star systems could be missed.

The likelihood that the sun could have been missed depends upon the number of species exploring, the time available for their exploration, their point of origin, and the location of our system when they passed our general area

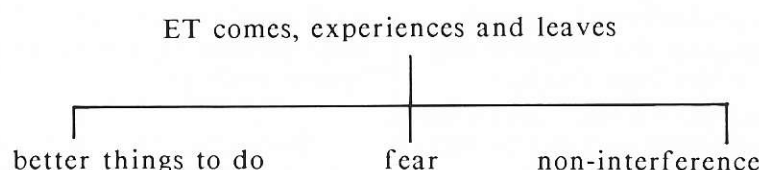
waves of ETs came by? Viewed in this way, we can see why we might have been missed. This would be the bad luck in the bad-luck hypothesis.

How bad would our luck have to be? This is difficult though not impossible to estimate. Carl Sagan once said that it was statistically possible for our system to be visited 10,000 times in the geological past. This guess was probably based on crude spherical-expansion modeling and even star distributions, but let's give him a 90-percent-error margin and say 1000 times ETs would have been sailing by our general area. The sun is in the arms about half the time or better, and when so it is a primary target for visitation, being a handy single optimal-life-bearing star. How about 500 ETI visitations in the past? To beat such odds, it seems that we would need very bad luck indeed.

Intuitive conclusions: We could have been missed through random bad luck of time and positioning, but it seems unlikely. If ETs explored, several civilizations probably got here.

Theory #3: the loss-of-interest hypothesis

Theory #3 decision tree



of the galaxy. The numbers of exploring civilizations were probably quite large, the time available also. Where they originated, in one sense, can be answered "everywhere," since sunlike stars speckle the entire disc. But the bulk of these civilizations will be nearer the galactic center, and they will also be the older ones.

If the galaxy is somewhat time-ordered with gradually newer civilizations appearing as you go outward toward the edge, then we are in the galactic boondocks and maybe easier to miss. As we have all seen, the Milky Way is shaped like a pinwheel with curved star-rich arms. Rational exploration of one sun to another would proceed more rapidly and thoroughly along those arms. This is of some possible relevance because our sun does not move at the same speed as the arm structures and moves in and out of them as it revolves around galactic center. Were we "in" or "out" of the arm structures when the exploration

Of all the scenarios imaginable to me, it seems most likely that our solar system was visited by some (perhaps many) exploring civilizations in the past. It seems so perfectly coherent with the natural course of things intelligent, curious and advanced. If so, it is most likely that the arrivals would have been in early evolutionary times, much before the dawn of human intelligence. So if they came and observed the early developing earth and left never to return, why?

The first category of loss of interest is just like Theory #1 only with the added implausibility of being interested to begin with, making a great discovery and then dropping it cold. The only creditable vision within this category (in my view) is the one wherein so many bustling ecosystems are discovered that it's impossible to closely study all of them at once. In my opinion this is *likely*. Nevertheless it is also difficult to

imagine a lack of occasional observation/monitoring to keep track of major developments (such as the possible arrival of native intelligence).

The "fear" idea is not exactly a "loss of interest," but on the surface it seems a reason to leave and not return. This fear could encompass the risk of possible infections from an alien biosphere. Perhaps the advanced civilization is composed of individuals whose bio-medicine has provided them extremely long lifespans; this has affected their behavior and made them low-risk-takers. Such individuals could be paranoid about alien biology. But they probably wouldn't be exploring in the first place, and the concept is schizophrenic. Add to this that their bio-medicine probably can easily handle any such difficulties and that organisms or even viruses from different biospheres probably won't be compatible enough to infect one another anyway, then this possibility seems farfetched indeed.

And what about ethics -- the noninterference-with-alien-life-forms idea? Maybe some civilizations will have acquired a sacred-garden view of the universe, or maybe just a wilderness-preserve concept. But these are explorers, and explorers explore. They observe and they experience and they learn. An advanced technical civilization could find many ways of continuing observation even under an extreme sacred-garden vision.

Intuitive conclusions: If we were visited sometime during our past, such an explorative culture would have been highly motivated to stay in some sort of contact. There may be many other important ecologies to observe closer to home, or they may adopt an extreme hands-off position. They will observe nonetheless.

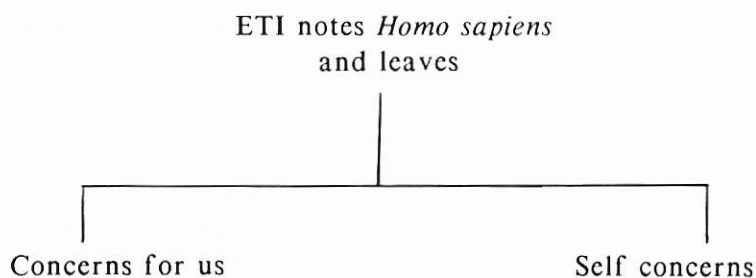
Theory #4: the ethics/morals-embargo hypothesis

Because the early "discovery" and frequent monitoring of the solar system seems the most likely of all the options, probably some advanced civilization noted the development of *Homo sapiens* on our planet. Our arrival introduced a new factor, a true tool-and-civilization-developing intelligence, and this factor may have caused changes in attitudes and decision-making. To stay or not to stay?

Although the observation of the development of any intelligent form (physically, psychologically, socially, technically, spiritually) would provide a rich field of curiosity and research, it could still be that the advanced intelligences would decide to leave. If they had an absolute rule of wisdom not to interfere with poorly-developed intelligent species (a category which surely *still* includes us, judging by our general behavior), then the only practical decision, given the irresistible temptation-to-intrusion such fascinating critters would present, would be regretfully to abandon the system entirely. Perhaps they would keep a very-long-distance electronic ear cocked in our direction to detect our emergence into the high-tech age.

Such a noninterference ethic would be appropriate for very advanced technologies feeling no threat from us, and very advanced cultures wise in the ways of the universe. For not-so-advanced civilizations, a true fear of a nearby intelligent species could exist. The concept "fear" always involves survival in some way: survival of their personal biology (infection); survival of their way of life (idea pollution); survival of their world (aggression). Biological threats of any magnitude seem unlikely, as stated previously. Idea pollution could create a threat to a totalitarian structure but is likely manageable, like all such things in that type of society. A

Theory #4 decision tree



massive aggression against the ETs' home world is not as absurd as it sounds. At the 1986 AAAS meeting the scientists were discussing how designs for near-light speed rockets would produce objects which would become so massive close to the speed of light that they might "crack a planet." In a paranoid galaxy it might be wise to keep your existence and location a secret. Even there, though, it seems that continued very discreet monitoring would be wiser.

Intuitive conclusions: Very advanced and nonthreatened civilizations might apply a Golden Rule of wisdom and leave us to natural, "sacred" destiny to do with our development as we will. If we were found and then abandoned, it is almost surely for concern for us. Purely selfish interests would point to continued surveillance at the least.

Theory #5: the ethics/morals-space-cousin hypothesis

So maybe they are here. And they're not "obvious." And, so, why not? Let's defend our sanity for a moment and then proceed. It's extremely likely that advanced intelligent civilizations appeared long ago in the galaxy. It's extremely likely that they could "hop" interstellarly and would have good motivations to do so. If they did explore, it's fairly likely that they'd have encountered our solar system since it contains a "target star." And they should have noticed the bio-forming earth. So the two most "ordinary" hypotheses are: they came and left, or they came and stayed. So "maybe they *are* here" should not be so crazy an idea.

If they are present somewhat continuously in the solar system and have not made themselves obvious to our species at large, they may be remaining secretive out of concern for us...just as in Theory #4. But their concern could be expanded beyond absolute noninterference and the sacred-garden view to a "moral-duty/intelligence-kinship" vision of their role. Such a position would spiritually require them to influence us in ways they viewed as positive. Such religious-philosophical influence could be delivered *overtly* in an evangelist missionary style of conversion (which is not happening; extraterrestrials are not handing out Alpha Centaurian Bibles on street corners), but, given our xenophobia as a species, such an approach would surely not work anyway. Any message of species enhancement or cultural redirection would

have to be implanted carefully from a hidden or at least obscured source.

Such subtle programming would be time-consuming. The ETI would have to be clever, disciplined and patient to produce desired civilizing effects upon our rock-and-roll shortvisioned and reactionary animal instincts. Still, religious motivation is an awesome thing and they might well think that it is worth it to elevate an unevolved species to full membership in the galactic congress of intelligent life forms.

Whether a civilization was extremely technologically advanced beyond our own or not, it might still be motivated by a morality of intelligent cousinship. The level of technical "tricks" would be relevant only in making their influence easier or more difficult, and safer or riskier to the individuals required to do the interactive work. All such scenarios would allow a puzzling, unfocussable UFO phenomenon, too obscure to induce destabilizing culture shock, but implanting new visions, feelings of species unity, life respect, familiarity with things "alien," disillusionment with power and materialism and competitiveness, and expanded cosmic awarenesses. If such was the major "program" being worked by the alien observer-manipulators, much of what is reported to go on in alleged abduction experiences would seem *unlikely*, however. The "rape," the powerless taking-and-using of abductees without overly great concern for their mental state, seems incompatible with the empathetic space-cousin concept. If such abduction reports reflect reality, they vote against this theory as the major hypothesis.

Intuitive conclusions: It is easy to imagine benign and concerned space cousins morally driven to aid a fledgling unevolved and struggling species. It is easy to see a lot of UFO phenomenology in coherence with this hypothesis. But the typical CE3 abduction scenario is *not* easily made coherent with this idea. A lot of mental gymnastics are necessary to glue the feelings of intellectual love and manipulative rape together.

Theory #6: the personal-needs hypothesis

Well, what if ETs are here and secretive and engaged in activities for their own purpose? What a novel concept, eh? It is, I hope I have shown, an eminently reasonable hypothesis that ETI could be around and operating secretly for its own (not necessarily injurious) purposes. In

fact, such a hypothesis could almost be called natural.

Extraterrestrial explorers could be, even should be, interested in observation and mildly intrusive research on an intelligent species. If they are anthropologists, they realize that they can't be overtly intrusive if they're to get their work done under as natural a set of conditions as such an "unnatural" interaction can be done. More cogently, they would be highly motivated not to skew the whole research project by introducing a wildly different element (them) to worldwide consciousness. They, as mostly hidden observers, are in the most advantaged of research positions. When you add to this scientific methodological point the reality of our violent emotions, kill instincts and fear of the unknown, the operation of the big research project under closed controlled conditions is so logical as to need no further defense.

So we all know this in ufology. The point is that the hypothesis is reasonable, even coherent with all current science. And it deals effectively with the majority of the phenomena of ufology, including the abductions. When we add a cool experimentalist's respect for other life forms (so as not to really hurt them), even the occasional "friendly alien" is incorporable. But most aliens are reported as "just doing their jobs." Nothing personal, human; just business. If the hypothesis is a reasonable one and not an assault on anything proven or strongly supported by current scientific data, there seems no need for shame in addressing the hypothesis, or any good objective reason for scientists to deny its viability.

Maybe scientists *do* secretly fear being part of a relatively impotent and imperfect ignorant species. Maybe that view of humanity and themselves is just too depressing or anxiety-inducing to contemplate. Maybe they block the hypothesis by the jerk-and-smirk barrier because serious contemplation would blow away a personal self-sufficiency fantasy which is dangerously insubstantial anyway. If the scientist is an atheist, and therefore has nothing to depend upon but self and a vague pride in human abilities, such an ET interaction might be more destabilizing to him than it would be to the majority of the population. Who knows? No study of the emotional stability of scientists, or more appropriately of debunking skeptics, has ever been done, despite the apparent crying need for such data. Other scientists who are not atheists (or, on the other hand, devotees of certain man-is-

everything religious groups) should not be so threatened and therefore should be educable.

Intuitive conclusions: The personal-needs hypothesis (with possible respect for life forms added) is legitimate in that it is not anti-scientific, makes sense of ufology for the most part and is eminently natural. Is it real? Well, in a strange way the question isn't even relevant at this point. All that is important here is that the question is a demonstrably serious one and that an affirmative answer is well possible.

Tentative last words

What do I think on this day in 1987? If I were to rate the probabilities of all the theories discussed, it would be:

Most favored: Theory #4 or Theory #6 (They came, saw us and left us alone; or they came and stayed for reasons of their own).

Next favored: Theory #5 (They came and stayed for our good -- but this theory demands a reappraisal of most abductions).

Next favored: Theory #2 (They traveled but missed us).

Next favored: Theory #1 (They never bothered to explore).

Next favored: Theory #3 (They came in early days and lost interest).

Unlikely: Theory #3 (Space travel is so difficult as to be essentially impossible).

Almost inconceivable: Theory #2 (We are the most advanced civilization).

Incredible: Theory #1 (We are the only intelligences).

Actually the first four visions are the only ones that have the vaguest ring of likelihood or naturalness to me. None of them violate science, logic or even most religion. They violate, it seems to me, only hang-ups. Anyone seriously pursuing UFO research should, it seems to me, be proud of himself and not at all defensive. Anyone who emotionally reacts ultra-positively or ultra-negatively should be self-conscious and defensive. One wonders what it would take to turn this backwards mindset around. Answers to *that* one won't be found in this discussion, I'm afraid.

Coming soon . . .

The JAL sighting: a special issue

The definitive account by Bruce Maccabee

Observation of an alien figure

by I. Scott

I. Scott, Ph.D., is a physiologist at the Ohio State University Medical School.

This possible UFO-related incident took place in September 1968 or '69 at approximately 9-10:00 P.M. in a wooded area by Alum Creek in Columbus, Ohio. I learned of it because, during an investigation seeking additional witnesses to a UFO observation over Columbus (*MUFON UFO Journal*, June 1986), I advertised in *The Columbus Dispatch* want-ads section.

The witness, Rick P., had written a description of his observation within approximately a year of its happening. He was in his early teens at the time of his experience. Excerpts from this account include:

"It was Monday night. The area was surrounded by woods and the street was unlit. It was getting cold since it was near the end of September. I turned to put the hay into the [rabbit] pen and heard a loud clapping noise. I turned and ... a creature! It was walking into the woods! It was dressed in a black uniform with a silver belt. Its arms and legs were long and very small like small pipes. The legs and arms moved in rhythm. But its head! ... it glowed with an eerie yellow glow. It was large and the shadows of the tree branches put dark streaks through the head. It had only impressions for eyes but no ears or brain.

"I stood there shocked. I should have followed it but did not. I ran to the house as fast as I ever ran before. I swung open the door screaming 'Mom, Dad!' As soon as they found out what had happened the whole family jumped into the car and they went out hunting for it. My parents said that it was probably someone dressed up. They told me to keep the story to myself."

In Rick's UFO sighting questionnaire (done in 1984), he made the following additional comments: "The next morning a neighbor girl, Joyce W., came to the door asking my mother if we had seen strange lights in the field the night before. Both of our parents went to the field and found a large oval place where the grass, weeds, and small trees had been pressed down (I never observed the lights or a vehicle). Again my

parents advised it was best to keep silent about the incident or people would consider me mentally ill (nuts)."

The first thing Rick thought about when he saw the body-shape was a person in costume. He then thought, however, that it was too tall and thin to be a person. In answer to several of my questions he told me the following:

He was around 70 feet from the figure at the closest. He estimated it was around seven feet high with arms and legs about an inch in diameter. The "head" was large, egg-shaped, and illuminated like a neon light. The eyes were impressions or indentations and they glowed also. He couldn't remember anything about a mouth or nose. He said the glowing "head" had streaks through it and he assumed the streaks were the branches of a nearby willow tree viewed against the illumination. Its belt was metallic, like silver, and contained an "instrument panel," but he couldn't remember details. The sound was from its feet hitting the pavement. He thought each foot was cubical in form. Although the street was unlit, he thought there had been enough light diffusing from the city for him to have seen details, because he distinctly remembered seeing its form.

I asked him whether he thought it was alive or mechanical. He said alive and seemed to have a pretty definite feeling about this. Yet in his 1960s description he remarked that it had no brain. He thinks he said that because the "head" seemed transparent. He said its "head" turned from side to side as it walked as if it were looking around. He thought that it didn't see him. Its walking was stiff rather than flexible and its joints did not appear to bend. He couldn't remember whether it swung its arms as it walked. He was frozen in fear at the time and couldn't move or scream.

I asked him if this took place on Halloween, but he believed it was in September and was sure it wasn't Halloween. He wanted to know what kind of medical research I did and said, "Are you using this UFO information as part of your research? I hope psychiatry is not your field!"

continued on page 25

The Delphos landing: new evidence from the laboratory

by Erol A. Faruk

Erol A. Faruk, Ph.D., is a chemist who lives in England.

Editor's note: *IUR* ordinarily does not publish technical papers. In this case, however, we are making an exception because of the importance of the findings described here, involving one of ufology's most-discussed cases. We are grateful to Dr. Faruk for allowing this article to appear here.

Among the alleged physical-trace reports in the UFO literature none, perhaps, have generated more interest and puzzlement than the Delphos, Kansas, case. This was a report in which not one but three apparently sane members of a farming family claimed to have witnessed an unusual low-level illuminated object which, after departing, left a "glowing" ring of soil in the ground. The ring was later sampled and photographed for all to see. Confirmation or disconfirmation of their claims might conceivably come from the analysis of that soil, and consequently samples were sent out to a total of 18 laboratories for investigation.

I was one of those who analyzed the soil, which I did in a spare-time capacity during 1977-9 while doing postdoctoral research at a British university. The results of that study, and its surprising conclusions, are summarized below for the benefit of *IUR* readers.

For those interested, a more detailed and technical report on the case is being published elsewhere. By their very nature, remarkable claims require rigorous substantiation if they are to be accepted, and my delay in publishing these findings stemmed, in part, from the expectation of conclusive data from certain U.S. soil laboratories which subsequently became interested in the ring. Their continued silence has forced my hand, and I leave it to the readers to decide for themselves, on the basis of the information, what the significance of the Delphos case is.

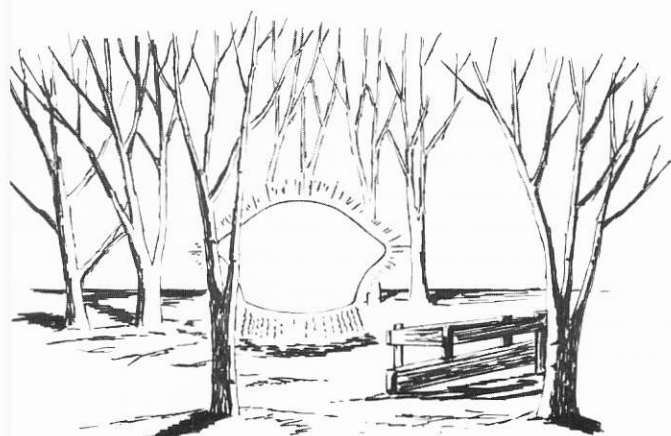


Fig. 1: UFO as it appeared from point of observation

The sighting

This has already been described at length by its principal investigator Ted R. Phillips, Jr.,¹⁻³ and only its more important aspects need be detailed here.

On November 2, 1971, at 7:00 P.M. local time a 16-year old boy, Ronald Johnson, was tending his sheep at his father's farm when he heard a rumbling noise like "an old washing machine that vibrates loudly" and the object was suddenly illuminated. The object was hovering about two feet off the ground under a tree about 75 feet away and was glowing brightly "like the light from a welder's arc" (Figs. 1, 2). The illumination did not come from individual lights but from the whole surface which was multi-colored, consisting of blue, red and orange glows.

The boy said his eyes hurt when he looked directly at the object and for several days after the incident his eyes were painful and he suffered headaches. The object had an estimated diameter of nine feet and appeared to be about 10 feet high. Ronald also observed a bright glow between the base of the object and the ground for the duration of the sighting (Fig. 2). After three to five minutes the object began to move off passing over a nearby shed by about four feet. Ronald called to his parents at the farm. They proceeded to the site and saw a ring of soil -- over which the object had hovered -- glowing in the dark. Looking up into the sky, they observed a bright luminescent object receding into the distance bearing "the color of an arc-welder." The glowing ring so impressed Mrs. Johnson that she ran back to the house to fetch a Polaroid camera with which she took a photograph of the effect.

The witnesses touched the ring which they described as having a cool "slick, crustlike" texture, as if the soil had "crystalized." They immediately experienced a "numbing effect" similar to that of a local anesthetic; it took several days or weeks to wear off. The Johnsons reported the alleged event to the local sheriff, who took samples and

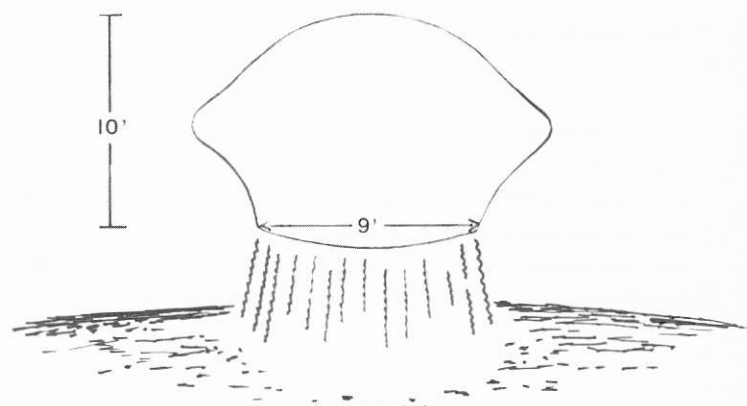


Fig. 2: The UFO



Fig. 3: Photograph taken nineteen hours after the alleged event

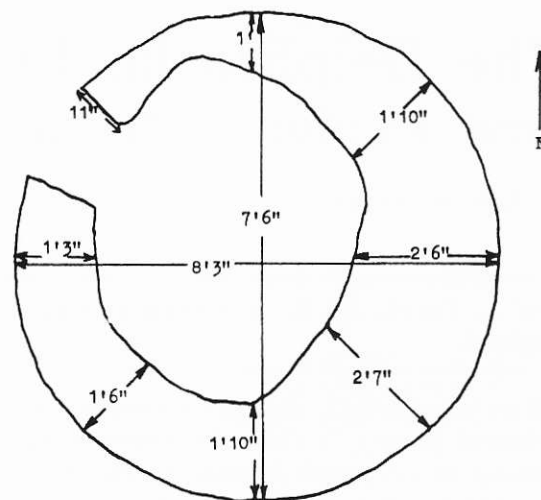


Fig. 4: Dimensions of ring soil

a photograph of the ring the next day (Fig. 3), and to a newspaper reporter.

Ted Phillips, Jr., arrived on the scene a month later to interview the family and measure and sample the ring soil. His initial report^{1,2} emphasized the credibility of the witnesses and the puzzling nature of the ring which now displayed pronounced hydrophobic character, so much so that it was still covered by unmelted snow, in contrast to the surrounding muddy environment. The hydrophobicity extended in places to 14 inches below the surface and lasted for some months afterwards. The ring had an unaffected portion at its northwestern edge while the whole was elongated towards the southeast (Fig. 4). A check of weather conditions prevailing at the time showed wind direction and speed to be 290 degrees and eight mph respectively suggesting a possible wind-spreading effect.

The initial excitement over the report receded when the photograph taken of the "glowing" ring was analyzed and found to show a high contribution of reflected moonlight by the surface. The photograph taken by the sheriff the day after the alleged event (Fig. 3) showed the ring to have a white surface color likely to render it visible in moonlight. This has generally been accepted as the most likely explanation for the purported "glowing" of the ring soil by the witnesses, although no account of the soil chemistry has yet been taken into consideration.

Materials and methods

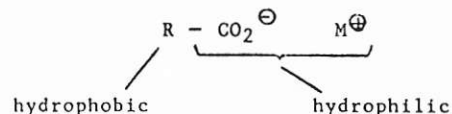
Soil samples taken from various locations and depths of the ring one month after the alleged event were received from Ted Phillips in late 1977. A sample of surface control soil taken outside the ring was also sent for comparison purposes. All samples had been kept refrigerated and sealed in airtight opaque containers to avoid general decomposition. The manipulation and analysis of the

material were carried out, employing standard organic chemical techniques.

Ring soil hydrophobicity

Samples of ring soil were initially inspected for their alleged hydrophobicity. They did indeed appear to be surprisingly impervious to water, contrary to the usual expectation for soil matter.

Further agitation, however, induced the aqueous soil mixture to disperse with a resultant loss in the hydrophobicity of the soil. Centrifugation of the suspension separated out the soil matter, leaving a clear brownish-yellow to red solution which was mildly alkaline and foamed on shaking such as a solution of household detergent would. These properties were consistent with the dissolved substance's being an alkali metal salt of an organic acid. Subsequent chemical manipulation supported this idea. Such a compound would consist of a hydrophobic organic residue -R linked to a hydrophilic carboxylate anion $\text{-CO}_2^\ominus\text{M}^\oplus$ (where M represents an unknown metal ion):



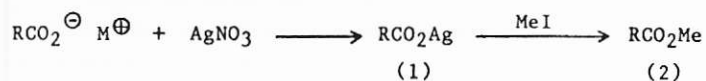
Further examination revealed that this substance and its direct decomposition products appeared to be the only ones "foreign" to the soil and hence were solely responsible for the observed hydrophobicity. The apparent paradox of a water soluble -- indeed, highly soluble -- organic compound's being responsible for the hydrophobicity can be explained in terms of a surfactant phenomenon: the normal hydrophilic components of the soil were coated or "bound-up" with those of the compound, leaving the

hydrophobic part (i.e., "R") to behave as the new "surface" of the soil. The action of wetting the soil disrupted these linkages and caused dissolution of the compound rendering it amenable to chemical analysis.

Subsequent testing of the unaffected control soil showed that impregnation by an aqueous solution of a salt of a known organic acid such as sodium anthraquinone-1-sulphonate imparted some degree of hydrophobic after allowing the mixture to dry. This revealed how such a reduction in soil absorptivity could be affected by the application of an aqueous solution of a suitable organic compound from an external source.

Chemical manipulation of ring soil extracts

To begin analysis of the ring compound, soil extracts were first treated with a slight excess of aqueous silver nitrate solution. An immediate precipitation of the corresponding silver salt (1) of the presumed carboxylic acid occurred as a reddish brown solid which was centrifuged off, washed and dried. The quantities of silver salt isolated in this way varied between CA 10-35mg per gram of ring soil depending upon location and depth of sampling. Negligible precipitation was observed when an extract of control soil was similarly treated. Subsequent reaction of the silver salt with excess methyl iodide in acetone for several hours afforded the corresponding methyl ester (2) of the acid which was soluble and imparted a yellow color to the solution:



The formation of the ester (2) allowed the soil compound to be examined by thin layer chromatography, a technique which can separate the mixture into discrete regions, or bands, of compounds. This revealed a major yellow band which was unstable and oxidized within minutes on exposure to air to give a product which had a blue fluorescence when viewed under ultraviolet (UV) light. This process was accompanied by a decolorization when observed under normal light. The compound could be eluted off the chromatogram and its light absorption spectrum recorded before it had fully oxidized. This showed maxima at 220, 290 and 358nm (Fig. 5a). The two longer

wavelength maxima decreased with time during the recording while there was a simultaneous increase in the 220nm peak (Fig. 5b). This change represents a decolorization of the compound and paralleled that observed on the chromatogram during oxidation.

Now that the light absorption properties of the purified material as a methyl ester had been determined, the information could be related to the light absorption curves of the crude ring soil extracts. The colors of these extracts varied with the depth of sampling; those from surface material were much lighter in color, in contrast to the distinctly reddish color observed for extracts taken from a few inches beneath the surface. The differences in the spectra of these extracts were consistent with the idea that a greater degree of oxidation (i.e., decolorization) of the soil compound had occurred towards the soil surface.

This was corroborated when, on one occasion, a spectrum of a red colored extract of subsurface material was recorded which was repeated only two minutes later to show a perceptible reduction in longer wavelength absorption, testifying to the high instability to air of the compound in its "natural" aqueous state. When more of this extract was treated with hydrogen peroxide as an oxidant, the red color was immediately discharged to give a pale yellow solution whose spectrum showed this decolorization to full effect. Evaporation of the oxidized solution yielded a whitish solid which may, I believe, give a clue as to the nature of the white surface color of the ring soil. The strong implication is that this has been caused by a layer of the fully oxidized compound coating the soil surface. As such, it might be what is being referred to as a "crustlike...crystalline" material on being touched by the witnesses.

Chemical analysis of the silver salt

It was apparent from the soil extract absorption spectra and chromatographic separation of the esterified material that considerable decomposition and oxidation of the compound had already occurred while in the soil. Because of this, techniques used to determine its chemical identity were of limited value. An infra-red spectrum of the dried silver salt showed strong hydroxyl and carboxyl stretching bands. The presence of both these groups would increase the water solubility of the compound as well as its surfactant properties, the latter giving rise to the unusual degree of

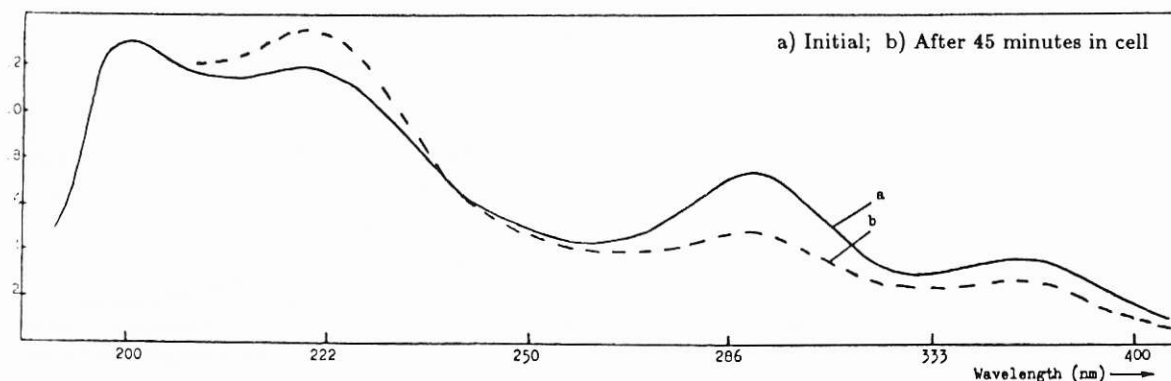
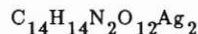


Fig. 5: Light absorption of esterified compound

hydrophobicity exhibited by the ring soil. A mass spectrum of the esterified material in combination with elemental analysis data of the silver salt suggested a rough empirical formula for the latter as shown below, though how close this might be to that of the pure compound is impossible to say without further purification and analysis.



Alleged local anesthetic effects

The presence of nitrogen in the compound may be of significance with regard to the anesthetic effects alleged by the witnesses. Local anesthetics generally contain nitrogen in the form of amino groups which are converted into their salt forms on absorption by the tissue to cause the anesthetic effect. Corroborative evidence might therefore come from determining the chemical nature of the nitrogen present in the soil compound.

It was found that a putrid odor indicative of a volatile amine was characteristically exuded from aqueous extracts of ring soil, suggesting its formation from a hydrolytic process. The concentrated form of this odor on inhalation produced an immediate but short-lived dizzying effect which was quite unpleasant. An attempt was made to trap out this suspected amine as its acid salt by bubbling into hydrochloric acid, but this only gave ammonium chloride on evaporation. This result was puzzling since the odor was not recognizably caused by ammonia.

Another possible cause of the anesthetic effect might come from the dual hydrophobic/hydrophilic property exhibited by the

compound and manifested, as described previously, in the hydrophobicity of the ring soil. Certain non-nitrogenous compounds containing this feature (e.g., benzyl alcohol) are capable of exhibiting local anesthetic effects which may be of additional significance.

Attempts to reproduce anesthesia on my own fingertips using aqueous extracts of ring soil left a peculiar sensation which couldn't be described as anesthetic, although this may be attributable to such factors as insufficient concentration of the extract, inadequate length of time in contact with the skin, or even decomposition of the chemical species responsible for the anesthetic effect. An answer to this aspect of the case can really only come from identifying the compound and its oxidation product and synthesizing them in their pure forms to test for the alleged effects.

From a study of the rate at which known anesthetics can penetrate unbroken skin one may assume that if the Johnsons are being truthful in their claims of an "immediate" numbing sensation it would suggest a high localized concentration of the compound responsible which arguably brings us back to the "crustlike crystalline" texture the witnesses noted. Another factor which may also be predicted is that the soil surface should have been wet or at least moist to provide intimate contact of the substance with the skin.

Chemiluminescence

Although the foregoing may be relevant to the alleged anesthetic effects, the real significance of the Delphos case lies, I believe, in the instability to air of the compound. The fact that it has

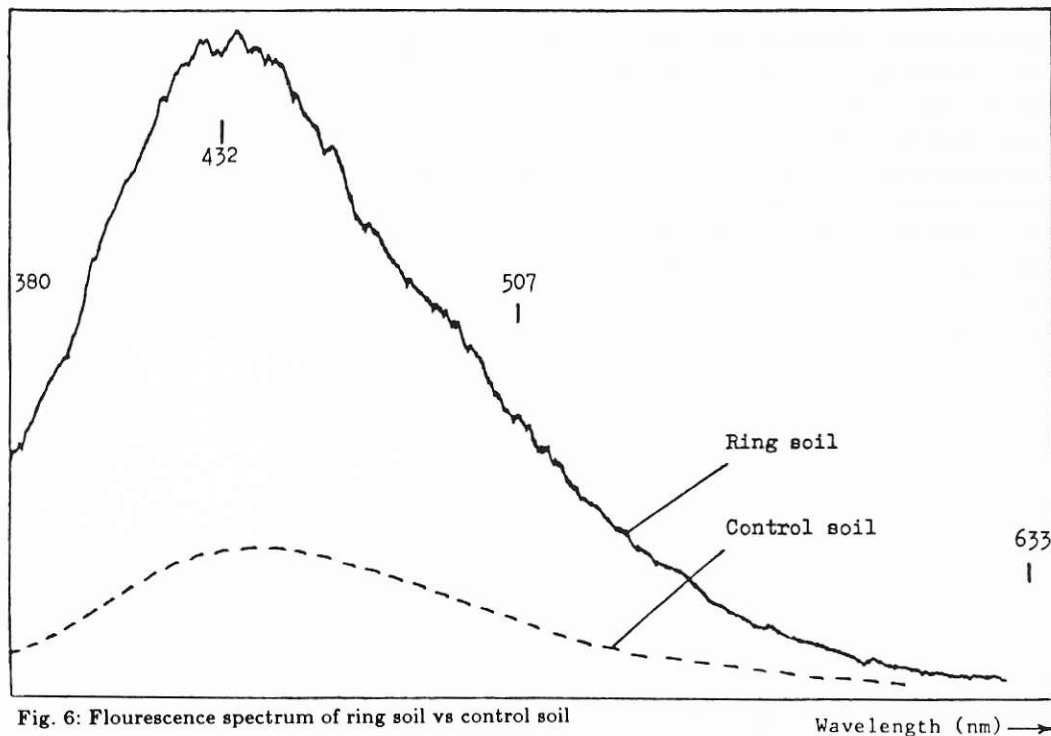


Fig. 6: Fluorescence spectrum of ring soil vs control soil

Wavelength (nm) →

the rather unusual property of oxidizing to give a fluorescent product when viewed under UV light leads to the prospect that chemiluminescence (i.e., chemically generated light) will be observed. This would, in turn, have implications on the alleged glowing of the ring soil. It would be inappropriate to describe this process -- more accurately called oxidative chemiluminescence -- in much detail here. In its simplest terms the phenomenon occurs because the energy liberated during oxidation may give rise to a proportion of the product molecules in an energy-rich form which could subsequently lose that energy in the form of light. Suffice it to say that during oxidation of the compound light emission is possible whose wavelength should be the same as that of the fluorescence of the product material.

Furthermore, as evidence of that emission, the fluorescent species should still be present in the soil after the emission had ceased, and would be apparent on irradiation with UV light. Centrifuged ring soil extracts all exhibited a bluish fluorescence when viewed under 366nm light and these peaked at 432nm when recorded on a fluorimeter. The control soil extract also fluoresced but was considerably weaker and peaked at 443nm. A direct comparison of the fluorescence of a surface ring soil extract against that of the control soil showed the former to be five times as bright (Fig. 6), a result which would not be inconsistent with the claim that the surface of the ring soil was "glowing."

The relationship of the ring soil fluorescence to the unstable compound present in the soil was apparent from a fluorescence spectrum also recorded of the product related material in esterified form derived from the chromatogram. This peaked at 429nm, the small difference (i.e., 3nm) being attributable to the different solvent being used for recording the spectrum. Thus, we have in the ring soil an unstable organic compound which oxidizes to give a fluorescent product, behavior which would entirely be expected for a potential chemiluminescent reaction.

My attempts to actually detect light emission from crude ring soil extracts failed, but this may have been due to factors having to do with the soil's being a month old when sampled. Again, until the soil compound is identified and synthesized or at least purified sufficiently, a proper demonstration of chemiluminescence may not be forthcoming.

Further work is required by laboratories equipped to cope with the problems inherent with the soil compound, a topic on which more will be said in the next issue of *IUR*.

This is Part One of a two-part article.

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2. Ted Phillips, "Landing Report from Delphos," in *1972 MUFON UFO Conference Proceedings*, ed. Walter H. Andrus, Jr., and Joseph N. Gurney. (Quincy, Illinois: Mutual UFO Network, 1972): 53-60.
3. Ted Phillips, "Close Encounters of the Second Kind: Physical Traces -- A Case in Point, Delphos, Kansas," in *1981 MUFON Symposium Proceedings*, ed. Walter H. Andrus, Jr., and Dennis W. Stacy (Seguin, Texas: Mutual UFO Network, 1981): 105-129.

Observation of an alien figure *continued from page 20*

The area where the observation took place, bounded by Agler, Purdue, Paul and Aberdeen Roads, still contains patches of dense vegetation. These connect to woods following the river for long distances. The figure turned at a stream and disappeared into a forest. Joyce W.'s house was across the street from his parents' house and is surrounded on two sides by woods (1986). Joyce saw lights in the woods from an upstairs-bedroom, east-facing window. Rick said that it would have been strange for anyone to have been in these woods at night and this is probably why Joyce's parents were concerned. The area of the mowed grass was around 1/8 mile from the spot where Rick saw the figure enter the woods, and woods stretch the distance between the two areas.

Rick is well-educated. He has a B.A. in technology, has attended Ohio State University and Mount Vernon Nazarene College and is half-finished with his M.S. in special education at Ohio State University. He was a missionary in Africa, has worked in public speaking and public relations for his church and is now teaching the mentally handicapped.

Rick's family remembers the incident, but not very much detail. His mother commented that at first his father didn't believe him, but since Rick had always been truthful, eventually he decided that Rick was telling the truth. Neither Joyce nor her family remembered the incident.

Rick concluded, "I wish I could offer more detail, but the incident occurred at least 15 years ago. Many, many times I've gazed up at the heavens taking in the vast beauty of the Milky Way and the untold number of far-off alien suns and wondered what it was that I saw and heard walking the dark alley so many years ago."

On the road (with visitors)

continued from page 11

we do not yet know what it is. The anecdotal evidence available suggests that we are being visited by extraterrestrials, but until that is proven by the public exposure of artifacts, we keep an open mind. That is certainly the public position, and it is the one that most of the investigators I have encountered feel most comfortable with.

Again and again on television and radio I made a case for open-mindedness and healthy skepticism and received strong positive response to this reasonable position.

People are suffering, and they deserve to be treated with dignity, even--perhaps especially--if what we are dealing with is not actual visitation but some sort of magnificent and unprecedented construction of the human mind.

Any theory that explains abductions must also explain why there are physical side-effects and scars, how the witness phenomenon functions, how multiple simultaneous abductions work, why there are so many shared details beyond the overall configuration of the beings seen, and--as well--why experiences that are otherwise absent from both folklore and current culture could possibly be shared in such detail by unrelated people.

Whenever I think of the frightened, prejudiced debunkers and their cruelties, I turn to the letters, to the gentle, open-minded outpouring from all those rational people. They have offered their prayers and their advice. I have received many clever theories and ideas and, above all, a wealth of narrative about the abduction experience and its complex aftermath.

The debunkers might be able to make a lot of noise, but the UFO community has a greater right to stand up, because it has not only the better case but the support of the public.

The media will be asking the debunkers some harder questions than they have been getting. And those questions will prove to be unanswerable. Frightened men will appeal in the end only to the fearful. The visitors--whoever they are--have given the UFO community a priceless gift. They have given it the public mind.

The community must treat that gift with all the respect that the debunkers routinely deny it. Clear, open-minded skepticism, questioning and testing everything as we move toward answers--this is the approach that will strengthen the bond between the UFO community and the public.

If we are to move toward the truth, it will be because the open-minded majority has found an open-minded leadership from within the UFO community. The community must have the courage to tell the truth: we don't know what is going on, but it is very real and very strange.

It is also extremely serious. By arguing these past 40 years about whether or not the phenomenon is real, we have in effect given it free rein to do with us what it will. We must put this absurd argument behind us and address the urgent questions of who and what the visitors are and what they may be doing here.

Contact of some sort may well be taking place. What does this mean to mankind?

Learning how to address and finally answer that question correctly is going to be an extraordinary challenge. The future existence of our species may well depend on it.

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CUFOS is moving . . .

As of May 1, 1987, the address of the J. Allen Hynek Center for UFO Studies will be 2457 West Peterson Avenue, Chicago, Illinois 60659.

The CUFOS Board agreed that a move to larger quarters was necessary to house our growing files, which will soon include the files of the National Investigations Committee on Aerial Phenomena. The NICAP material comprises a vital part of UFO history and it will now be easily accessible to serious students and researchers.

The Board has also decided that from now on CUFOS will not sell commercially-available books. CUFOS will continue to sell its own publications, including the soon-to-be-printed *Spectrum of UFO Research: Proceedings of the 1981 CUFOS Conference*, containing papers by J. Allen Hynek, Bruce Maccabee, J. Gordon Melton, Budd Hopkins, Roberto Pinotti, Vicente-Juan Ballester Olmos, Mark Rodeghier and others.

Michael Swords to edit CUFOS *Journal*

The *Journal of UFO Studies*, CUFOS' refereed scientific publication, is being revived under the editorship of Michael D. Swords, Ph.D., associate professor of natural science at Western Michigan University. The last issue of the *Journal*, Volume III, appeared in 1983.

Swords graduated from the University of Notre Dame in 1962 with a B.S. degree in chemistry. Three years later he received his M.S. in biochemistry from Iowa State University and in 1972 completed work for his Ph.D. in history of science and technology at Case Western Reserve University.

At Western Michigan (where in 1978 he was given the university's teaching excellence award) he teaches courses in human biology, the history and philosophy of science, scientific methodology, and anomalies studies (including ufology). Swords is a member of the American Association for the Advancement of Science, the American Association of University Professors and the L-5 Society. He is also a consultant to the Mutual UFO Network.

"Ufology needs a refereed journal," he says. "Both of our sister fields in anomalistics, parapsychology and cryptozoology, have refereed journals open to a number of viewpoints. Archaeoastronomy, near-death studies and now general anomalistics (via the Society for Scientific Exploration) are producing journals.

"We all have certain things in common. We are involved with phenomena that demand interdisciplinary approaches. Consequently we do not have a recognizable publication outlet. And because of our interdisciplinary nature, most narrowly-trained (and often narrow-thinking) academic departmentalists view our fields from limited perspectives, if not outright bias. This further limits publication potential, or indeed any entry into academic forums.

"If a serious forum is important to us, we must, it appears, create one for ourselves. The *Journal* will encourage objectivity, critical analysis and the truth-seeking process in general.

"I am hoping for the cooperation and tolerance of the community of intellects interested in ufology. We need good research, good manuscripts

and scientific attitudes. We also need fair and timely referees."

Interested persons are encouraged to write Dr. Swords at the Department of General Studies, Western Michigan University, Kalamazoo, Michigan 49008.

Letter

To the editor:

Are hypnotically-recalled abduction scenarios a result of fantasies? According to *Webster's New Collegiate Dictionary*, in the context of psychology a fantasy is an imaginative sequence fulfilling a psychological need; a daydream, in other words. In Budd Hopkins' *Missing Time* (1981), Dr. Aphrodite Clamar, who has conducted hypnotic regression sessions with a number of alleged abductees, says of her subjects: "Their fantasies are different from those of 'ordinary' people -- but only if you assume that the experiences they report are fantasies. The common variety of fantasy most of us indulge in at one time or another creates a special and pleasurable situation in which we succeed...."

There are people in our society who view UFOs as vehicles manned by benevolent Space Brothers who have come to save us. For these individuals, a UFO sighting would most likely be a special or pleasurable experience. In this case, a fantasy explanation could not be ruled out.

But the experience revealed by an alleged abductee is another matter. Being taken against one's will by strange beings, stripped naked, examined, and subjected to pain is no one's idea of a pleasurable experience or the fulfillment of a psychological need.

*Tom Burns
New Milford, New Jersey*

The BUFORA conference

BUFORA (the British UFO Research Association) is 25 years old this year. Since it shares this anniversary with the 40th year of ufology, following Kenneth Arnold and his Cascade Mountains experience, it is to be marked with another of the celebrated International Congresses.

The first three such events were held in London and the surrounds during 1979, 1981 and 1983. All lost money heavily. Nonetheless, the three-day meetings attracted hundreds of researchers from all over the world and a series of papers of variety and high standard. They also launched ICUR (the International Committee for UFO Research) -- with associated members from leading bodies throughout the world (including CUFOS). International Congresses, including this one, always start off with an ICUR meeting on the day before the proceedings commence.

For the 1987 gathering some major changes have been made. The congress has been formulated by a consortium of businessmen investing capital to fund the requirements. Eyecatchers, an audio-visual promotions agency, is responsible for setting it up on a commercial footing. But virtually all of the people who have invested in the congress are experienced and recognized UFO researchers -- mostly current or former officers of BUFORA. BUFORA, as an organization, is a major shareholder in the project -- under the guidance of its council -- and in exchange for capital funding is being allowed to promote the event under its name.

It is anticipated that this approach will make for professionally-organized congress and an impressive line-up, combined with the absence of a financial burden on the UFO community. In an effort to give those who wish to attend maximum flexibility, a wide range of package deals involving day attendance, discount attendance for the whole three-day program, optional extra sessions on the days before and after the congress, with meals, accommodations and other frills included or excluded, is being offered. This should enable the congress to be within the reach of anyone who can get to London in July 1987.

The program, being finalized as I write this, will include surprises and novel items. Papers

already scheduled come from the leading investigators and research groups in Europe (including Dr. Alex Keul on the Austrian witness project and Odd Gunnar Roed from Norway on the famous Project Hessdalen experiments). Overseas contributors include Walt Andrus of MUFON and Prof. Allen Tough of Canada. Since the program is being designed to accommodate shorter papers, the number of presentations across the three days will be large, varied and sophisticated.

This will certainly be one of the events of the decade in European ufology. If you can make it, please do. The dates are July 10-12, 1987. The location is the London Business School, Regents Park.

For details write to Congress 87, 16 Southway, Burgess Hill, Sussex RH15 9ST, England. -- *Jenny Randles*

1987 MUFON symposium

The International Symposium on Unidentified Aerial Phenomena: 1947-1987 will be held at American University in Washington, D.C., on June 26, 27 and 28. Sponsored by the Mutual UFO Network and the Fund for UFO Research and commemorating 40 years of the UFO controversy, it promises to be a major event in modern UFO research. Speakers from 10 nations are scheduled to appear and the scientific level is certain to be high. The host chairman is FUFOR head Dr. Bruce Maccabee.

The fee for all symposium events is \$30 (\$35 if received after June 1). Dormitory rooms are available for \$25 (double) and \$27 (single) for each night between June 25 and 27.

Checks should be made payable to Fund for UFO Research, Box 277, Mount Rainier, Maryland 20712.

Those who prefer motel accommodations may wish to contact Connecticut Avenue Day's Inn, 4400 Connecticut Avenue, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20008 (telephone number 202/244-5600). Room rates there are \$59 a night for a single or double room.